

Team name: Magic Number

# MyDesign Portfolio

## *Element A*

### Presentation and Justification of the Problem

#### Problem Statement and Details (A1, A2, A5)

The people involved in this problem are young children who might be struggling with and lacking social connection. What they are doing is they are often too shy to participate. There is no unique situation that this instance occurs. The size of this issue is high, because “Four in 10 Americans say they are completely or mostly introverted” ([YouGov](#) poll). This problem is happening inside schools. The problem occurs because kids are often very reserved and reluctant to participate with others. Introversion is a natural personality trait that creates an individual difference in the inclinations toward the inner and outer world (Jung, [1921](#)).

MyDesign Portfolio - Element A Initial Template

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#### Stakeholder Concerns and Connections (A3, A4)

One stakeholder is the librarian. She is a stakeholder because she wants to create an environment where kids enjoy their time and develop social skills. Another stakeholder are the kids themselves, because they are the ones who could be potentially struggling to socialize on their own and need something else to initiate social engagement. Another group of stakeholders would be other staff at the school. The reason why they are stakeholders is because they care about students and would like to see them socializing. Another group of stakeholders is the parents. They are stakeholders because they want their kids to have friends and have fun at school, rather than being isolated.

#### Problem Importance (A6)

This problem is very important because getting social interactions at a young age is very crucial for a child's development ([Taylor and Francis](#)). Research clearly suggests: “Social relationships and interactions are **crucial for social, emotional, and cognitive learning processes**... warm and supportive interactions significantly contribute to successful learning in early childhood.” ([Taylor and Francis](#)).

Today, kids are not getting those interactions to the same degree. In the U.S., young people are also **spending about 45% more time alone than they did in 2010**, showing a clear decline in real-life social interaction ([Our World In Data](#)). This problem needs to be solved because students need more social interaction, and they need something to pull them out of their shells and get them to engage.